

ART AND CULTURE



CULTURAL INSTITUTIONS & AWARDS

FAMOUS CULTURAL INSTITUTIONS (PART- III)

MODULE – 3



INDIAN COUNCIL OF HISTORICAL RESEARCH



- 1 The Indian Council of Historical Research (ICHR) was established under the promulgation of the Societies Registration Act in 1972
- 2 It was created with the express purpose to **promote and preserve the history of India.**
- 3 It was a platform for the historians to come together and discuss new ideas or their current work.

INDIAN COUNCIL OF HISTORICAL RESEARCH

4 The ICHR is a very active body that conducts seminars, conferences, etc which would promote historical knowledge.

5 They also provide Junior and Senior fellowships and financial assistance to the scholars and historians for their research.



6 They publish journals like the Indian Historical Review in English and the 'Itihas' in Hindi, which contain scholarly research articles on history.

7 They also maintain a library and documentation centre for the purpose of reading and circulation of books.

8 They have two regional centres in Bangalore (South) and Guwahati (North-East) that cover the functions in their specific areas.

INDIAN COUNCIL OF HISTORICAL RESEARCH



NATIONAL MISSION FOR MANUSCRIPTS

- 1 The National Mission for Manuscripts was established in February 2003, by the Ministry of Tourism and Culture.
- 2 The Archaeological Survey of India and the National Archives of India had encountered a large number of manuscripts that are the repositories of the ancient and medieval heritage of India.
- 3 It is on their recommendation that the Government of India has ordered for the establishment of the NMM.
- 4 The foremost task of the NMM was to **create a database of the manuscripts**.
- 5 This database has about one million manuscripts, which makes it the largest database of Indian manuscripts in the world.
- 6 Another major task of the NMM was to **conserve the manuscripts using indigenous and modern methods** so as to preserve documents while retaining its ancient heritage.

NATIONAL MISSION FOR MANUSCRIPTS



Digitization of Manuscripts

7

Other important tasks for the NMM are:

- It has to **train the coming generation of manuscript conservators through diploma and degree courses.**
- NMM trains those working with manuscripts on issues of languages, scripts and critical editing.
- Equal importance should be placed on the **cataloguing of texts and conservation of the manuscripts.**
- They are given funds by the Government of India to procure the best techniques and to digitize the rare and the most endangered manuscripts.
- They want the readers, scholars, linguists, historians to engage with the manuscripts through lectures, seminars and publication of the critical editions of the unpublished manuscripts and catalogues.

NATIONAL MISSION FOR MANUSCRIPTS



DIGITISATION OF MANUSCRIPTS

- Digitization means acquiring, converting, storing and providing information in a computer format that is standardized, organised and available on demand from common system.
- Manuscripts are converted into compressed digital formats with specialized scanners and stored systematically for future reference.

NATIONAL MISSION FOR MANUSCRIPTS



WHY DIGITIZE?

- To promote access to manuscripts
- For preservation in a longer lasting medium and creating a back up copy with as close a resemblance to the original as possible.
- To reduce handling of very fragile or frequently used original manuscripts
- This vast archival resource will be accessible to users through the National Manuscripts Library to be eventually set up by the Mission.

Digitization is the primary step in order to preserve the contents of the Manuscripts. It is essential to save the Manuscript treasure and its knowledge base as much as possible before it is lost forever keeping in view the condition of the ancient Manuscripts.

NATIONAL MISSION FOR MANUSCRIPTS

CHALLENGES BEFORE THE MISSION

- The manuscript wealth of India is estimated at around ten million manuscripts and is perhaps the largest collection in the world.
- Manuscripts are found in a vast number of languages and scripts many of which **can no longer be read**.
- Manuscripts are found in **different kinds of repositories**—ranging from museums, institutions of learning to private homes and houses of worship, big and small.
- Manuscripts are often found to have been neglected for decades and in **very poor physical state**—insect ridden, fungus infected or brittle, fading and fragile.
- And finally, and perhaps most critically, there is a **major lack of connection between so-called 'modern knowledge' and the knowledge contained in manuscripts**.



NATIONAL MISSION FOR MANUSCRIPTS

CHALLENGES BEFORE THE MISSION

- Scholars who can study and use manuscripts are **fast disappearing** and a new generation of scholars is not able to rise to the challenge.
- Often, the knowledge in manuscripts is not seen as **relevant** to our times.
- Now that there is world-wide interest in traditional systems of medicine such as Ayurveda and Unani, building science such as Vaastu Shastra and in older canons of literature and philosophy, there is **revival of the search for manuscripts**.
- But more importantly, manuscripts need to be saved for their importance as records of India's past, society, culture and politics—as records of India's memory!



SAHITYA AKADEMI



साहित्य अकादेमी

- 1 The Government of India established the “National Academy of Letters” or the Sahitya Academi in 1954.

- 2 The primary function of this organisation was to work as a national organisation to **promote literary culture in India**, to foster and co-ordinate literature in all the Indian languages and to overall promote the national unity of the country.

- 3 It is an autonomous organisation, which undertakes literary activities in over 24 Indian languages.

- 4 Apart from the 22 languages that are mentioned in the Constitution of India, the Sahitya Academi gives recognition to two more languages: English and Rajasthani.

SAHITYA AKADEMI

Some of these awards are:

Name of the Award**Sahitya Akademi Award****Bhasha Samman Award****Prize for Translation****Bal Sahitya Puraskar****Yuva Puraskar**

5 They have several awards and fellowships that honor the great contribution made to linguistic development by writers.

6 For the last few years their collective focus has shifted to the **preservation of the Oral and tribal literature**.

7 Our ancient society and traditional knowledge was transferred as oral knowledge and that needs to be preserved for the coming generations.

8 It has also tried to reach to a wider audience through the organization of **literary gatherings like: Samvad, Meet the Author, Kathasandi, Mulakat, Asmita, etc.**

SANGEET NATAK AKADEMI



National Academy of Music, Dance & Drama

- 1 The Sangeet Natak Akademi was the first national academy set up for the **Music, Dance and Drama** by the Government of India in 1952.

- 2 The Akademi became functional the following year with the appointment of its first chairman **Dr. P.V. Rajamannar** and inaugurated by the first President of India, **Dr. Rajendra Prasad**, inaugurated it.

- 3 The Sangeet Natak Akademi is presently an Autonomous Body of the Ministry of Culture, Government of India and is fully funded by the Government for implementation of its schemes and programmes.

- 4 The major focus of the academy was to create a set-up for music, drama and dances of India.

SANGEET NATAK AKADEMI



- 5 It was supposed to be the primary body for showcasing the performing arts in the country.
- 6 They also had the ardent task of promoting the enormous intangible heritage of India as demonstrated through the forms of music, dance and drama.
- 7 They are not only supposed to be the central agency to monitor the preservation of our cultural heritage but they need to collaborate with the State and Union territory governments to preserve and promote their culture on a national platform.

CULTURAL INSTITUTIONS OF INDIA

SANGEET NATAK ACADEMI



- 8 The Sangeet Natak Akademi also looks after several institutions, which focus primarily of either dance or music or drama.
- 9 For example, they administer the National School of Drama that was set up in 1959 for focused work on dramatics in India.
- 10 They also collaborate with international organizations like UNESCO to save the cultural heritage of India

SANGEET NATAK ACADEMI



11 Sangeet Natak Akademi has established several institutions over the years like Manipur Dance Academy, Sattriya Centre, National Institute of Kathak Dance etc.

12 It has also established certain centres for some traditional art forms:

- ✓ Centre for Kutiyattam, Thiruvananthapuram, a national projects in the support of Kuttiyattam (the age-old Sanskrit theatre of Kerala)
- ✓ Chhau Centre, Baripada/ Jamshedpur.

CULTURAL INSTITUTIONS OF INDIA

To encourage the establishment of theatre centres, on the basis of regional languages, and co-operation among different theatre centers.

To encourage the setting up of institutions providing training in the art of theatre, including instructions in actor's training, study of stage-craft and production of plays.

To promote research in the fields of Indian music, dance and drama and for this purpose, to establish a library and museum, etc.

To co-ordinate the activities of regional or State Academies of music, dance and drama.

To revive and preserve folk music, folk dance and folk drama in different regions of the country and to encourage the development of community music, martial music and other types of music

To foster cultural contacts between the different regions of the country and also with other countries in the fields of music, dance and drama.



Some of the objectives of Sangeet Natak Akademi

LALIT KALA ACADEMY



- 1 The **National Academy of Art** or the Lalit Kala Academy was set up by the Government of India in 1954 with the sole object to promote fine arts in India

- 2 The academy is an autonomous body that is funded by the Ministry of Culture.
- 3 They focus on the encouragement and understanding of fine arts.
- 4 Although they deal with national and international art, their focus is on the promotion and preservation of Indian art.
- 5 Their main centre is in Delhi and they have Regional Centres in places like Chennai, Kolkata, Lucknow, and Bhubaneswar etc.

LALIT KALA ACADEMY



Rabindra Bhawan, Delhi which houses the Sangeet Natak Akademi, Lalit Kala Akademi and Sahitya Akademi.

- 6 They organize national and international exhibitions and event showcasing the works of the artists patronized by the Lalit Kala Academy.
- 7 Important exhibitions include the National Exhibition of Art, International Triennale India etc.
- 8 They also have the task to preserve the long tradition of visual arts in India.

LALIT KALA ACADEMY

- 9 They have established centres to preserve and document a permanent collection, which focuses on the modern and contemporary art in India. This collection features the art of many contemporary Indian legends.
- 10 Apart from this they have also created **an archive and a library** that has a substantial art collection.
- 11 They now have a conservation laboratory and are materially sound.
- 12 They also try to promote visual culture by **providing scholarships and grants to artists and art organizations**.
- 13 They **give financial assistance** and grants to deserving and needy artists.
- 14 They also **organise several functions** that would bring the varied visual cultures of India together to get a **panoramic view of Indian cultural heritage**.

AWARDS AND HONOURS

AWARDS GIVEN BY GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

SAHITYA AKADEMI AWARD



- 1** This is an honour given to those who achieve brilliance in literature.
- 2** This award was instituted in 1954 and is given by the 'Sahitya Akademi' that is the National Academy of Letters of our country.
- 3** It is given annually to those who have achieved literary merit and created new trends by publishing their works, prose or poetry, in any of the 24 major languages recognised by the Akademi.

AWARDS AND HONOURS

AWARDS GIVEN BY GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

SAHITYA AKADEMI AWARD



The very famous Indian filmmaker Satyajit Ray designed the plaque.

- 4 Besides the 22 languages enumerated in the Constitution of India, Sahitya Akademi has recognised English and Rajasthani as languages in which programmes can be implemented and hence can be considered for the award.
- 5 The award comprises a cash prize of 1 lakh rupees and a plaque which says 'Sahitya' in the Devanagiri script.

AWARDS AND HONOURS

AWARDS GIVEN BY GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

SAHITYA AKADEMI AWARD

1959	Ramdhari Singh Dinkar	Hindi
1960	R.K Narayan	English
1968	Harivansh Rai Bachchan	Hindi
1956	Amrita Pritam	Punjabi
1988	Vikram Seth	English
1975	Kaifi Azmi	Urdu
2004	Ghulam Nabi Firaq	Kashmiri
1967	Buddhadeb Basu	Bengali
2012	K. Satchidanandan	Malayalam

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